

Decisions and in Advanced GCE Economics and Business through Unit 3: International Business and Unit 4b: The Wider Economic Environment and Business. In Unit 3 students are required to draw on their knowledge of how a business operates and apply it to an overseas context. Units 4a and 4b will be assessed via a decision-making report designed to test the ability of students to think at a higher strategic level to address complex issues and problems. The context of the decision-making report will be pre-released on www.edexcel.org.uk.

Stretch and challenge

Students can be stretched and challenged in A2 units through the use of different assessment strategies, for example:

- using a variety of stems in questions – such as, explain, examine, assess, compare, provide the case for and against, justify, analyse, evaluate
- ensuring connectivity between sections of questions – for example through use of data response questions where answers are applied to the supplied context
- a requirement for extended writing in Units 3, 4a and 4b
- use of a wider range of question types to address different skills – for example open-ended questions, case studies, decision-making report etc
- use of supplied data to enable students to make deductions that support answers.

Additional information

Malpractice and plagiarism

For up-to-date advice on malpractice and plagiarism, please refer to the *Joint Council for Qualifications — Suspected Malpractice in Examinations: Policies and Procedures* document on the JCQ website <http://www.jcq.org.uk/>

**Access
arrangements
and special
requirements**

Edexcel's policy on access arrangements and special considerations for GCE, GCSE, and Entry Level aims to enhance access to the qualifications for learners with disabilities and other difficulties (as defined by the Disability Discrimination Act 1995 and the amendments to the Act) without compromising the assessment of skills, knowledge, understanding or competence.

Please see the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk/sfc) for:

- the JCQ policy Access Arrangements and Special Considerations, Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations.
- the forms to submit for requests for access arrangements and special considerations
- dates for submission of the forms.

Requests for access arrangements and special considerations must be addressed to:

Special Requirements
Edexcel
One90 High Holborn
London
WC1V 7BH

**Disability
Discrimination Act**

Please see *Appendix 7* for Advanced GCE in Business Studies and Economics and Business Disability Discrimination Act information.

Prior learning and progression**Prior learning**

There are no prior knowledge requirements for this qualification. The specification builds on, but does not depend upon, students having followed a course in GCSE Business, GCSE Economics or GCSE Business and Economics.

Progression

The qualification provides a solid foundation for studies at a higher level in the following subject areas: business management, business administration, accountancy and finance, human resource management, marketing, retail management, tourism management and international business.

The qualification may also lead on to a career in the commercial world, for example in banking, sales, product management or general management. Business and management skills are also considered desirable skills to have in public sector organisations or charities.

Combinations of entry**Forbidden combinations are:**

- Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business and Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics.
- Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business and Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Business Studies.

Student recruitment

Edexcel's access policy concerning recruitment to our qualifications is that:

- they must be available to anyone who is capable of reaching the required standard.
- they must be free from barriers that restrict access and progression.
- equal opportunities exist for all students.

Key skills

This qualification provides opportunities for developing and generating evidence for assessing the key skills listed below:

- application of number
- communication
- information and communication technology
- improving own learning and performance
- problem solving
- working with others.

Further details are available in *Appendices 2 and 3*.

This qualification will be mapped to functional skills once they are finalised. Information will be available on our website (www.edexcel.org.uk/gce2008) at a later date.

The wider curriculum

This qualification provides opportunities for developing an understanding of spiritual, moral, ethical, social and cultural issues, together with an awareness of citizenship, environmental issues, health and safety considerations, and European developments consistent with relevant international agreements appropriate as applied to Business and Economics and Business. *Appendix 4: Wider curriculum* maps the opportunities available.

E Resources, support and training

Resources to support the specification

In addition to the resources available in the *Getting Started* guide book, Edexcel produces a wide range of resources to support this specification.

Edexcel's own published resources

Edexcel aims to provide the most comprehensive support for our qualifications. We have therefore published our own dedicated suite of resources for teachers and students written by qualification experts. These resources include:

- schemes of work
- student guide
- mapping document to previous GCE specifications
- lesson materials.

Edexcel publications

You can order further copies of the specification and specimen examination papers from:

Edexcel Publications
Adamsway
Mansfield
Notts
NG18 4FN

Telephone: 01623 467467
Fax: 01623 450481
Email: publications@linneydirect.com
Website: www.edexcel.org.uk

Additional resources endorsed by Edexcel

Edexcel also endorses additional materials written to support this qualification.

Any resources bearing the 'Endorsed by Edexcel' logo have been through a rigorous endorsement quality assurance process to ensure complete and accurate support for the specification. For up-to-date information about endorsed resources, please visit www.edexcel.org.uk/endorsed.

Please note that while resources are checked at the time of publication, materials may be withdrawn from circulation and website locations may change.

The resources listed are intended to be a guide for teachers and not a comprehensive list. Further suggestions can be found in *Appendix 6: Further resources and support*.

Please see www.edexcel.org.uk/gce2008 for up-to-date information.

Support

Edexcel support services

Edexcel has a wide range of support services to help you implement this qualification successfully.

ResultsPlus — ResultsPlus is a new application launched by Edexcel to help subject teachers, senior management teams, and students by providing detailed analysis of examination performance. Reports that compare performance between subjects, classes, your centre and similar centres can be generated in 'one-click'. Skills maps that show performance according to the specification topic being tested are available for some subjects. For further information about which subjects will be analysed through ResultsPlus, and for information on how to access and use the service, please visit www.edexcel.org.uk/resultsplus.

Ask the Expert — Ask the Expert is a new service, launched in 2007, that provides direct email access to senior subject specialists who will be able to answer any questions you might have about this or any other specification. All of our specialists are senior examiners, moderators or verifiers and they will answer your email personally. You can read a biography for all of them and learn more about this unique service on our website at www.edexcel.org.uk/asktheexpert.

Ask Edexcel — Ask Edexcel is Edexcel's online question and answer service. You can access it at www.edexcel.org.uk/ask or by going to the main website and selecting the Ask Edexcel menu item on the left. The service allows you to search through a database of thousands of questions and answers on everything Edexcel offers. If you don't find an answer to your question, you can choose to submit it straight to us. One of our customer services team will log your query, find an answer and send it to you. They'll also consider adding it to the database if appropriate. This way the volume of helpful information that can be accessed via the service is growing all the time.

Examzone — The examzone site is aimed at students sitting external examinations and gives information on revision, advice from examiners and guidance on results, including re-marking, re-sitting and progression opportunities. Further services for students — many of which will also be of interest to parents — will be available in the near future. Links to this site can be found on the main homepage at www.edexcel.org.uk.

Training

A programme of professional development and training courses, covering various aspects of the specification and examination, will be arranged by Edexcel each year on a regional basis. Full details can be obtained from:

Professional Development and Training
Edexcel
One90 High Holborn
London
WC1V 7BH

Telephone: 0870 240 9800

Fax: 0845 359 1909

Email: trainingenquiries@edexcel.org.uk

Website: www.edexcel.org.uk

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Appendix 1 Performance descriptions

Introduction

Performance descriptions have been created for all GCE subjects. They describe the learning outcomes and levels of attainment likely to be demonstrated by a representative candidate performing at the A/B and E/U boundaries for AS and A2.

In practice most candidates will show uneven profiles across the attainments listed, with strengths in some areas compensating in the award process for weaknesses or omissions elsewhere. Performance descriptions illustrate expectations at the A/B and E/U boundaries of the AS and A2 as a whole; they have not been written at unit level.

Grade A/B and E/U boundaries should be set using professional judgement. The judgement should reflect the quality of candidates' work, informed by the available technical and statistical evidence. Performance descriptions are designed to assist examiners in exercising their professional judgement. They should be interpreted and applied in the context of individual specifications and their associated units. However, performance descriptions are not designed to define the content of specifications and units.

The requirement for all AS and A level specifications to assess candidates' quality of written communication will be met through one or more of the assessment objectives.

The performance descriptions have been produced by the regulatory authorities in collaboration with the awarding bodies.

AS performance descriptions for Business Studies

	Assessment objective 1	Assessment objective 2	Assessment objective 3	Assessment objective 4
Assessment objectives	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified content.	Apply knowledge and understanding to problems and issues arising from both familiar and unfamiliar situations.	Analyse problems, issues and situations.	Evaluate, distinguish between and assess appropriateness of fact and opinion, and judge information from a variety of sources.
A/B boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: a demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the key business concepts in the AS specification, with few significant omissions.	Candidates characteristically: a demonstrate the ability to apply relevant knowledge to familiar and unfamiliar business contexts b show knowledge and understanding of the issues arising from these situations.	Candidates characteristically: a analyse problems, issues and situations: ■ build logical arguments ■ use appropriate numerical and non-numerical techniques.	Candidates characteristically: a distinguish between fact and opinion b assess the appropriateness of information from a variety of sources c make a reasoned evaluation of the sources considered.
E/U boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: a demonstrate a basic knowledge and some understanding of the business concepts in the AS specification.	Candidates characteristically: a demonstrate the ability to apply a basic level of relevant knowledge to familiar business contexts b show some knowledge and understanding of the issues arising from these situations.	Candidates characteristically: a provide partial analysis of problems, issues and situations: ■ build arguments ■ use appropriate numerical and non-numerical techniques.	Candidates characteristically: a make some distinction between fact and opinion b assess at a basic level the appropriateness of information from one or more sources c make a partial evaluation of the sources considered.

A2 performance descriptions for Business Studies

Assessment objectives	Assessment objective 1	Assessment objective 2	Assessment objective 3	Assessment objective 4
A/B boundary performance descriptions	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified content. Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate precise knowledge and understanding of key business concepts drawn from the A2 specification, with few omissions - b show knowledge and understanding of the links between business concepts.	Apply knowledge and understanding to problems and issues arising from both familiar and unfamiliar situations. Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate effective application of relevant knowledge to familiar and unfamiliar business contexts - b show knowledge and understanding of the issues arising from these situations.	Analyse problems, issues and situations. Candidates characteristically: - a critically analyse business problems, issues and situations: ■ build logical arguments ■ use appropriate numerical and non-numerical techniques - b analyse a business strategy - c develop a business strategy.	Evaluate, distinguish between and assess appropriateness of fact and opinion, and judge information from a variety of sources. Candidates characteristically: - a distinguish between fact and opinion - b assess critically the appropriateness of information from a wide variety of sources - c make a well-reasoned evaluation of the sources considered.
E/U boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate knowledge and some understanding of business concepts drawn from the A2 specification - b show some knowledge and understanding of the links between business concepts.	Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate the application of relevant knowledge to familiar and unfamiliar business contexts - b show some knowledge and understanding of the issues arising from these situations.	Candidates characteristically: - a provide a simple analysis of business problems, issues and situations: ■ build arguments ■ use appropriate numerical and non-numerical techniques - b outline a business strategy.	Candidates characteristically: - a distinguish between fact and opinion - b assess the appropriateness of information from several sources - c make an evaluation of the sources considered.

AS performance descriptions for Economics

	Assessment objective 1	Assessment objective 2	Assessment objective 3	Assessment objective 4
Assessment objectives	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified content.	Apply knowledge and understanding of the specified content to problems and issues arising from both familiar and unfamiliar situations.	Analyse economic problems and issues.	Evaluate economic arguments and evidence, making informed judgements.
A/B boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate detailed knowledge of a range of facts and concepts included in the AS specification - b demonstrate clear understanding of: ■ terminology ■ institutions ■ models.	Candidates characteristically: - a apply: ■ concepts ■ numerical and graphical techniques ■ theories and models ■ terminology to issues arising in familiar and unfamiliar situations.	Candidates characteristically: - a select relevant concepts, models, theories and techniques - b demonstrate, for the most part, developments of logical explanations of economic problems and issues with focus and relevance.	Candidates characteristically: - a evaluate straightforward economic arguments and evidence by: ■ prioritising evidence and arguments ■ making judgements ■ reaching and presenting conclusions.
E/U boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate knowledge of some facts and concepts included in the AS specification - b demonstrate some understanding of: ■ terminology ■ institutions ■ models.	Candidates characteristically: - a apply in part some of the following: ■ concepts ■ numerical and graphical techniques ■ theories and models ■ terminology to issues arising in familiar situations.	Candidates characteristically: - a demonstrate some evidence of selecting relevant concepts, models, theories and techniques - b demonstrate partial explanations of economic problems and issues.	Candidates characteristically: - a evaluate straightforward economic arguments and evidence at a simple level, for example by: ■ offering judgements ■ stating conclusions.

A2 performance descriptions for Economics

	Assessment objective 1	Assessment objective 2	Assessment objective 3	Assessment objective 4
Assessment objectives	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified content.	Apply knowledge and understanding of the specified content to problems and issues arising from both familiar and unfamiliar situations.	Analyse economic problems and issues.	Evaluate economic arguments and evidence, making informed judgements.
A/B boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: demonstrate, across the AS and A2 specifications: - detailed knowledge of a range of facts and concepts - clear understanding of: - terminology - institutions - models - detailed knowledge and clear understanding of the interconnections between the different elements of the subject content.	Candidates characteristically: - apply clearly and effectively: - concepts - numerical and graphical techniques - theories and models - terminology to complex issues arising in familiar and unfamiliar situations.	Candidates characteristically: - select relevant concepts, models, theories and techniques - demonstrate, for the most part, development of logical explanations for complex economic problems and issues, with focus and relevance.	Candidates characteristically: - evaluate effectively complex economic arguments: - prioritise evidence and arguments - make reasoned judgements - reach and present supported conclusions - make reasoned recommendations.
E/U boundary performance descriptions	Candidates characteristically: demonstrate, across the AS and A2 specifications: - knowledge of some facts and concepts - some understanding of: - terminology - institutions - models - some knowledge and understanding of the interconnections between the different elements of the subject content.	Candidates characteristically: - apply appropriately some: - concepts - numerical and graphical techniques - theories and models - terminology to complex issues arising in a range of situations, some of which may be unfamiliar.	Candidates characteristically: - demonstrate some evidence of selecting relevant concepts, models, theories and techniques - demonstrate partial development of logical explanations for complex economic problems and issues.	Candidates characteristically: - demonstrate some evaluative skills in relation to complex economic arguments and evidence: - make judgements - reach and present conclusions with some supporting evidence - make recommendations.

Appendix 2 Key skills mapping

Key skills (Level 3)	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Application of number				
N3.1	✓			
N3.2	✓			
N3.3	✓			
Communication				
C3.1a			✓	
C3.1b	✓	✓	✓	✓
C3.2	✓	✓	✓	✓
C3.3	✓	✓	✓	✓
Information and communication technology				
ICT3.1	✓	✓	✓	✓
ICT3.2	✓	✓	✓	✓
ICT3.3	✓	✓	✓	✓
Improving own learning and performance				
LP3.1	✓	✓	✓	✓
LP3.2	✓	✓	✓	✓
LP3.3	✓	✓	✓	✓
Problem solving				
PS3.1				✓
PS3.2				✓
PS3.3				✓
Working with others				
WO3.1	✓	✓	✓	✓
WO3.2	✓	✓	✓	✓
WO3.3	✓	✓	✓	✓

Appendix 3 Key skills development

Achievement of key skills is not a requirement of this qualification but it is encouraged. Suggestions for opportunities for the generation of Level 3 key skill evidence are given here.

Application of number — Level 3

Plan and carry out one or more activities that each includes tasks for all three of N3.1, N3.2 (a or b or c or d) and N3.3.

Overall, through one or more activities students must:

- use two different types of sources, including a large data set, ie over 50 items of data (N3.1)
- carry out calculations to do with a, b, c and d (N3.2)
- present findings in two different ways using charts, graphs or diagrams (N3.3).

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
N3.1	Plan an activity and get relevant information from relevant sources.	Unit 1	Students could plan how to get research information on potential demand for a new business idea, eg through secondary data from different sources and primary research data from at least 50 respondents. Students should justify why their sources of secondary data and chosen sampling method for the primary research are appropriate. They should then use these research methods to gather the information.
N3.2	Use this information to carry out multi-stage calculations to do with: a amounts or sizes b scales or proportion c handling statistics d using formulae.	Unit 1	Students should use collected primary research data to carry out multi-stage calculations to find out: ■ level of demand (amount of people likely to buy) ■ frequency of purchase (mode) ■ likely market share (proportion likely to buy of the target or total population) ■ the proportional change in market size over time from secondary data to show that market is growing ■ how to use formulae in spreadsheets to aid with data analyses of results. Students should use checking procedures to identify errors in methods and results, eg has the student got the same number of responses to a question as the number of people surveyed?

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
N3.3	Interpret the results of your calculations, present your findings and justify your methods.	Unit 1	Students should select and use appropriate methods to present their findings, show trends and make comparisons (perhaps between the popularity of new business ideas, preferred packaging etc). Any tables, charts, graphs and diagrams used should be constructed and labelled using accepted conventions. Students must examine critically and justify their choice of presentation method, for example a pie chart is not an appropriate method for presenting this information because the proportional differences are difficult to see for smaller numbers. Students must describe what their results tell them and whether they meet the purpose of their activity, for example would they ideally need to gather more information and if so, what would that be?

Communication — Level 3

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
C3.1a	Take part in a group discussion.	Unit 3	Students could be given a case study scenario whereby a company is seeking an international market in which to sell its product. Students could assess the likely attractiveness of particular country markets to this company based on the product and the specification's assessment criteria. Students should provide notes of what they intend to say in the discussion. Students are expected to make clear and relevant contributions in the discussion in a way that suits the purpose of the task and the situation. After the discussion the student must record how they encouraged others in the group to contribute to the discussion and how they demonstrated an awareness of others' feelings, beliefs and opinions. A signed teacher witness statement for the discussion is also needed.
C3.1b	Make a formal presentation of at least eight minutes using an image or other support material.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Following a period of research on any substantial topic in the specification, students could be given the opportunity to present their findings to the rest of the group. During the presentation students should speak clearly and use a style that is appropriate to their audience and to the subject. The presentation should have a logical structure that allows the audience to follow the sequence of information and ideas. The presentation should include an appropriate range of techniques such as the use of examples to illustrate complex points, audience experience used to involve the audience, tone of voice varied etc. Where appropriate, images (tables, charts, diagrams, maps etc) should be used to illustrate points and to help engage the audience. At least one image should be used and commented upon in the presentation.

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
C3.2	Read and synthesise information from at least two documents about the same subject. Each document must be a minimum of 1000 words long.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students will need to be given the opportunity to research a topic for an essay/report or for the presentation in C3.1b from two extended documents, such as textbooks or articles. One of the extended documents must contain an image, for example a table, chart or diagram. The student should select the document themselves. A photocopy of the extended documents used should be provided. As they carry out their research students should identify accurately and compare the main points, ideas and lines of reasoning from the text and images. They then need to present their own interpretation of the subject in a way that is coherent and brings together information from the different documents in a relevant form, for example presentation, report etc.
C3.3	Write two different types of documents, each one giving different information about complex subjects. One document must be at least 1000 words long.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students are required to produce two types of document. At least one should be an extended document, for example a report or essay of at least 1000 words long. In Unit 2b, for example students could investigate the effect of online retailing on market price and demand for certain products. The other document could be the presentation handout used for C3.1b. The document should have a form and style of writing which is fit both for its purpose and for the complex subject matter covered. At least one of the documents should include an appropriate image that contains and effectively conveys relevant information. Specialist vocabulary should be used where appropriate and the information in the document should be clearly and coherently organised, for example through the use of headings, paragraphs etc. Students should ensure that the text is legible and that spelling, punctuation and grammar are accurate.

Information and communication technology — Level 3

Show that students can plan and carry through a number of different tasks, one of which must be a major task covering ICT3.1, ICT3.2 and ICT3.3.

Each component, ICT3.1, ICT3.2 and ICT3.3, must be covered at least twice, and ICT3.3 must be covered for at least two different audiences. Smaller tasks may be used to ensure each component is covered.

Overall, through at least two activities students must:

- include at least one ICT-based information source
- include at least one non-ICT-based information source
- use at least one example of text, one example of image and one example of number
- use one example of combined information such as text and number, or image and number or text and image
- present evidence of purposeful use of email; one of these emails must have an attachment related to the task.

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
ICT3.1	Search for information, using different sources, and multiple search criteria in at least one case.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	When producing work, students will have numerous opportunities to use relevant ICT in all units. The internet could be used to collect information. Students will need to plan which electronic sources they are going to use based on judgement of their relevance to the task and quality. Students must choose appropriate search techniques for finding the information, for example a database query. One piece of research must have been obtained through use of multiple search criteria. Students must organise the completed research work by use of subfolders. Examples of activities might be: ■ obtain information on assessment criteria for country markets (Unit 3, 3.4) ■ analysis of past sales data in a spreadsheet as part of secondary research for a new or differentiated product idea (Unit 1, 1.2).

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
ICT3.2	Enter and develop the information and derive new information.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students are required to bring together, in a consistent format, their selected information and use automated routines as appropriate, eg a data format or table structure. Students should use software features to improve the efficiency of their work, such as the LOOKUP function in spreadsheets to check entries or make database queries. Students should sort and group the information generated, producing spreadsheets, graphs and charts if appropriate, to allow them to draw conclusions. For example, students could be working towards giving a presentation of their conclusions based on different scenarios. Information could be presented in handouts and/or as part of an automated slide show. Students should annotate their work to show that they understand the processes followed and that they have taken account of the views of others, for example early drafts could be emailed to their tutor for feedback.
ICT3.3	Present combined information such as text with image, text with number, image with number.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students should develop the structure of the presentation or report by applying referencing facilities such as page numbers, dates and file names. The presentation or report should be developed and refined by combining text, images and numbers for example, by use of hyperlinks or slide transition features. Tutors may provide early feedback on layout, content and style that will result in formatting changes (early drafts should be kept as portfolio evidence). The final output should be in an appropriate format to meet the purpose of the task and the needs of the audience, for example a presentation handout. The document should be spelled accurately and have been proof-read.

Improving own learning and performance — Level 3

Provide at least one example of meeting the standard for LP3.1, LP3.2 and LP3.3 (the example should cover at least three targets). Overall, students must show they can use at least two different ways of learning to improve your performance.

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
LP3.1	Set targets using information from appropriate people and plan how these will be met.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	In the AS specification, understanding how to calculate break-even revenue (Unit 1) or the application of supply and demand analysis (Unit 2b) offers the opportunity for each student to set their own particular skills targets in a learning plan and work to meet those targets, with appropriate support from others, for example their tutor. Students will need to review their progress and overcome possible difficulties. In the A2 specification, students could plan to improve their essay writing, examination or data response skills.
LP3.2	Take responsibility for your learning, using your plan to help meet targets and improve your performance.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students need to use their plan effectively when improving their skills. This will involve prioritising action, managing their time and revising their plan as necessary. Students should seek and use feedback and support and draw on different approaches to learning. They are, however, required at times to work independently.
LP3.3	Review progress and establish evidence of your achievements.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students should review their own progress and factors affecting the quality of their learning and performance. They should identify targets met, providing evidence of achievements from relevant sources. They should consult with others, for example their tutor, to agree action for improving their performance.

Problem solving — Level 3

Provide at least **one** example of meeting the standard for PS3.1, PS3.2 and PS3.3. The example should include exploring at least **three** different ways of tackling a problem (for PS3.1).

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
PS3.1	Explore a problem and identify different ways of tackling it.	Units 4a/b	Students will need to identify, analyse and accurately describe the problem and agree three different ways of solving it. They must select and use a variety of methods, for example written, visual, numerical to come up with different ways of tackling the problem. Students must compare the main features and risks of each potential method of tackling the problem and use this information to justify the method they decide to use. For example, in Unit 4a Making Business Decisions, much of the content of this unit lends itself to problem solving. This would include critical path analysis, decision trees and investment appraisal. In Unit 4b, students are asked to examine possible government policies which could address issues such as obesity or binge drinking. Students could be given real-life problems to tackle before applying their knowledge to examination questions.
PS3.2	Plan and implement at least one way of solving the problem.	Units 4a/b	Students are required to plan their chosen way of solving the problem and get the go-ahead from a person who has expertise in the problem-solving area. For example, decision trees could be used to select the best way of solving the problem and then students could check their chosen solution with their teacher or project supervisor. Students must put their plan into action, effectively using support and feedback from others to help tackle the problem. They must regularly check their progress towards solving the problem, revising their approach as necessary.
PS3.3	Check if the problem has been solved and review your approach to problem solving.	Units 4a/b	Students are required to identify methods for checking that the problem has been solved and agree with a person who has expertise in the problem-solving area the methods to be used. Students must apply these methods systematically to check if the problem has been solved. They must fully describe the results and draw conclusions on how successful they were. They must review the strengths and weaknesses of each stage of their approach, including whether other approaches could have proved more effective.

Working with others — Level 3

Provide at least **one** example of meeting the standard for WO3.1, WO3.2 and WO3.3, to include work in a group or team situation. Students must check progress on two occasions (for WO3.2).

Key skills portfolio evidence requirement		AS/A2 unit	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
WO3.1	Plan work with others.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students could work in groups of 6 – 8 and investigate a given topic. Initial work will require identifying and agreeing realistic objectives for working together and planning how to meet them, including any necessary action and resources required. The group needs to agree individual roles, responsibilities and working arrangements. There are examples of topics that could be suitable for group work in each unit of the specification.
WO3.2	Seek to develop co-operation and check progress towards your agreed objectives.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Students will need to organise and carry out their tasks efficiently to meet their responsibilities and seek effective ways to develop co-operation and resolve conflict to maintain appropriate working relationships. Students must share accurate information on their progress, agreeing changes where necessary to achieve objectives.
WO3.3	Review work with others and agree ways of improving collaborative work in the future.	Units 1, 2a/b, 3, 4a/b	Once completed, the full group needs to review outcomes against the agreed objectives. They must agree the extent to which work with others has been successful and identify factors, including their role, that have influenced the outcome. They must agree on ways in which they could improve their work with others in the future, including their own interpersonal skills.

Appendix 4 Wider curriculum

Signposting

Issue	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Spiritual	✓			
Moral		✓	✓	
Ethical	✓	✓	✓	
Social		✓	✓	✓
Cultural			✓	✓
Citizenship			✓	
Environmental			✓	✓
European initiatives			✓	✓
Health and safety		✓		

Development suggestions

Issue	AS/A2 units	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
Spiritual	Unit 1	How leaders/managers motivate employees and how people are motivated at work. What motivates entrepreneurs, for example profit and non profit motives.
Moral	Unit 2	Recruitment, training and employment practices in the light of equal opportunities legislation.
	Unit 3	Exploitation of workers by multinationals through payment of low labour wages.
Ethical	Unit 1	Characteristics of entrepreneurs – ethical stance.
	Unit 2	Use of restrictive trade practices by businesses to gain unfair advantage.
	Unit 3	Ethical decisions by companies as to what and where to manufacture etc. Potential conflicts of ethically responsible behaviour with profit-based and other objectives. Harm that multinationals can do – use of agents to bribe government of company officials in order to gain market entry or competitive advantage in a foreign country.

Issue	AS/A2 units	Opportunities for development or internal assessment
Social	Unit 2	Social cost of unemployment, structural unemployment.
	Unit 3	Increased trade worldwide creating a negative influence on employment in highly industrialised countries. Attractiveness of country markets in the light of their culture and social infrastructure and their likely impact on the ability of the business to trade or set up in the market. Different promotional messages necessary for trading in different countries
	Unit 4	To what extent should the government intervene to regulate behaviour with issues like obesity, binge drinking etc? Changing pattern of demand for goods and services. Threat to some established businesses.
Cultural	Unit 3	Attractiveness of country markets in the light of their culture and social infrastructure and their likely impact on the ability of the business to trade or set up in the market. Different promotional messages necessary for trading in different countries
	Unit 4	Classification of company cultures and their influence on corporate objectives.
Citizenship	Unit 3	Can multinationals be controlled – pressure groups.
Environmental	Unit 3	Implications of trading internationally, for example emissions, waste disposal. Harm that multinationals can do – use of unsustainable resources in a foreign country.
	Unit 4	To what extent should the government intervene to regulate behaviour, for example to protect the environment, promote recycling, reduce the use of cars etc.
European initiatives	Unit 3	European union – facilitation of trade and constraints of EU membership.
	Unit 4	Role of EU Commission in regulating markets.
Health and safety	Unit 2	Induction training – legal requirement for health and safety training for new recruits.

Appendix 5

Codes

Type of code	Use of code	Code number
National classification codes	Every qualification is assigned to a national classification code indicating the subject area to which it belongs. Centres should be aware that students who enter for more than one GCE qualification with the same classification code will have only one grade (the highest) counted for the purpose of the school and college performance tables.	Business Studies — 3210 Economic and Business — 3230
National Qualifications Framework (NQF) codes	Each qualification title is allocated a QCA National Qualifications Framework (NQF) code. The QCA National Qualifications Framework (NQF) code is known as a Qualification Accreditation Number (QAN). This is the code that features in the DfES Funding Schedule, Sections 96 and 97, and is to be used for all qualification funding purposes. The QCA QAN is the number that will appear on the candidate's final certification documentation.	The QANs for the qualifications in this publication are: Business Studies AS — 500/2444/9 Advanced GCE — 500/2443/7 Economics and Business AS — 500/2462/0 Advanced GCE — 500/2442/5
Unit codes	Each unit is assigned a unit code. This unit code is used as an entry code to indicate that a candidate wishes to take the assessment for that unit. Centres will need to use the entry codes only when entering candidates for their examination.	Business Studies Unit 1 – 6BS01 Unit 2a – 6BS02 Unit 3 – 6BS03 Unit 4a – 6BS04 Economics and Business Unit 1 – 6EB01 Unit 2b – 6EB02 Unit 3 – 6EB03 Unit 4b – 6EB04
Cash in codes	The cash-in code is used as an entry code to aggregate the student's unit scores to obtain the overall grade for the qualification. Centres will need to use the entry codes only when entering candidates for their qualification.	Business Studies AS – 8BS01 Advanced GCE – 9BS01 Economics and Business AS – 8EB01 Advanced GCE – 9EB01
Entry codes	The entry codes are used to: 1 enter a candidate for the assessment of a unit 2 aggregate the candidate's unit scores to obtain the overall grade for the qualification.	Please refer to the Edexcel Information Manual available on the Edexcel website.

The following resources may be useful.

Books

Unit 1: Developing New Business Ideas and Unit 2a: Managing the Business

Burke R — *Small Business Entrepreneur* (Cosmic mba series, 2006) ISBN 0-9582391-6-9

Burke R — *Entrepreneurs Toolkit* (Cosmic mba series, 2006) ISBN 0-9582391-4-2

Gillespie A, Surridge M — *A2 Business Studies* (Hodder Arnold, 2005) ISBN 9780340900918

Gillespie A, Surridge M — *AS Business Studies* (Hodder Arnold, 2004) ISBN 9780340885413

Lines D, Marcouse I — *Business Case Studies AS and A level* (Longman, 2002) ISBN 0582406366

Lines D, Martin B, Marcouse I — *Complete A-Z Business Studies Handbook* (Hodder Arnold, 2006) ISBN 0340915161

Oxford Revision Guides — *AS and A level Business Studies Through Diagrams* (Oxford University Press, 2005) ISBN 0199150680

Unit 2b: Business Economics

Anderson I, Anderson F — *Easy Mark Economic Exercises for AS Level* (Anforme, 2004) ISBN 0907529844

Anderton AG — *Economics AS Level* (Causeway Press, 2006) ISBN 1902796934

Anderton AG — *Economics: Teacher's Guide* (Causeway Press, 2006) ISBN 1902796942

Bamford C and Munday S — *Markets* (Studies in Business and Economics) (Heinemann, 2002) ISBN 0435332236

Clift P, Simpson G — *AS Economics: The Market Economy Topic Cue Cards* (Philip Allan Updates, 2005) ISBN 1844893561, 2003) ISBN 074877081X

Dransfield R — *Key Ideas in Economics* (Nelson Thornes, Gavin M — *AS Economics Unit 1 Edexcel: Markets – How They Work* (Philip Allan Updates, 2004) ISBN 0860039129

Etherington I, Smith C and Smith M — *Revision Express Economics* (Pearson Education, 2006) ISBN 1405807458

Gillespie A — *AS and A Level Economics Through Diagrams* (Oxford University Press, 2005) ISBN 0199150710

Grant S, Ellams A and Vidler C — *Heinemann Economics AS for Edexcel* (Heinemann, 2005) ISBN 0435330772

Hearn J — *AS/A-level Economics Essential Word Dictionary* (Philip Allan Updates, 2000) ISBN 0860033708

Jewell M — *Key Definitions for Economics 'A' Level Revision: For Edexcel Students* (Anforme, 2005) ISBN 0907529984

Munday S — *Studies in Economics and Business: Markets and Market Failure* (Heinemann, 2000) ISBN 0435330500

Nutter R — *AS Economics Multiple Choice Workbook* (Philip Allan Updates, 2005) ISBN 1844891127

Wall N — *Complete A-Z Economics Handbook* (Hodder Arnold, 2003) ISBN 0340872756

Unit 3: International Business

Dahringer L, Leihns H and Muhlbacher H — *International Marketing. A Global Perspective* (Thomson Learning, 2006) ISBN 9781844801329

Deresky H — *International Management Managing Across Borders and Cultures: International Edition* (Prentice Hall, 2005) ISBN 0131968580

Fowler P and Watkins K — *Rigged Rules and Double Standards: Trade, Globalisation and the Fight Against Poverty* (Oxfam Academic, 2003) ISBN 0855985259

Gooderham P and Nordhaug O — *International Management: Cross-boundary Challenges (Management, Organizations and Business* (Series Blackwell Publishing, 2003) ISBN 0631233423